Alina Pfrang

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Education and Experience

Aug 2025–Present	**Stanford University, Stanford, CA** *Postdoctoral Fellowship* Graduate School of Business & Stanford Tax Lab
Feb–Jun 2025	**University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA** *Visiting Scholar* Tippie College of Business, Accounting Department
2020–2025	**University of Mannheim, Germany** *PhD in Accounting* Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences Research Stays: **University of Texas at Austin**, Jan–Mar 2024, Host: Prof. Lisa De Simone **University of Iowa**, Apr–Jun 2024, Host: Prof. Jaron Wilde
2018–2020	**University of Mannheim, Germany** *MSc in Business Administration*
2015–2018	**University of Passau, Germany** *BSc in Economics*

Research

Interests: Real effects of business taxation, Environmental tax policy, Tax compliance regulations, Anti-tax avoidance

Publication

"**How to Improve Small Firms' Payroll Tax Compliance? Evidence from a Randomized Field Experiment**" with Philipp Doerrenberg and Jan Schmitz. *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, 2026, 4(3).

Job Market Paper

"**Firm Responses to Clean Energy Tax Credit Transfers: Investment, Tax Planning, and Disclosures**" *Working Paper*.

Clean energy tax credits are a primary policy tool for governments to encourage firms to invest in renewable energy. However, many clean energy firms are not tax-paying, rendering the credits unusable and potentially ineffective. The U.S. Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) of 2022 substantially changed the policy to permit firms to sell the credits for cash, providing immediate liquidity to the clean energy sector. This created a new multi-billion dollar market that significantly increased access to clean energy tax credits. Using a hand-collected dataset of disclosed tax credit transfers combined with financial and plant-level electric generator data, I examine how both selling (clean energy firms) and buying (unrelated companies) firms respond to this new market. On the seller side, I use difference-in-differences designs to examine investment responses and project quality. I find that selling firms increase capital

expenditures and the number of electric generators after their first transfer, with the increase concentrated in clean technologies. On the buyer side, I show that participation in tax credit financing expands sharply and draws in new firms across many industries. Buying firms are more profitable and have higher ESG scores than other potential buyers. Finally, I show that buyers' effective tax rates decline following a purchase, and they incorporate these purchases into the environmental disclosures of their sustainability reports. Overall, my paper provides policy-relevant evidence that transferability shifts both real investment in clean energy and the set of firms financing green technologies.

Working Papers

"**Do Substance Rules Have Substance? Firm Responses to Anti-Tax Avoidance Rules**" with Emilia Gschossmann. *Working Paper*.

"**Tax Reporting Simplification and Firm Behavior**" with Philipp Doerrenberg and Christin Schmidt. *Working Paper, submitted to the Journal of Accounting Research*.

"**The Impact of Environmental Taxes on Commercial Traffic and Its Environmental Consequences**" *Working Paper*.

Work in Progress

"**Stacking Taxes: Local Business Taxes and Political Feedback**" with Rebecca Lester. *Work in Progress.*

Policy Work

"**Rethinking Anti-Tax Avoidance Measures in the European Union**" with Johannes Gaul, Alexander Goebel, Emilia Gschossmann, Hannah Gundert, Felix Jungmann, Daniel Kaeshammer, Cornelia Kindler, Thu Thao Porebski, Christin Schmidt, Katharina Schmidt, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Julia Spix, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *ZEW Discussion Paper*, 2026.

"**Comments on the Call for an Evaluation of the Anti-Tax Avoidance Directive**" with Johannes Gaul, Alexander Goebel, Hannah Gundert, Emilia Gschossmann, Felix Jungmann, Christin Schmidt, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Julia Spix, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *EU Consultation Anti-Tax Avoidance Directive*, 2024.

"**The Global Minimum Tax – Costs and Benefits from a German Perspective**" with Johannes Gaul, Jessica Mueller, Daniel Klein, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *Der Betrieb* 76 (1), 2023.

"**Significant Costs, Limited Benefits: A Global Minimum Tax in Germany**" with Johannes Gaul, Jessica Mueller, Daniel Klein, Inga Schulz, Christoph Spengel, Stefan Weck, Sophia Wickel, and Sarah Winter. *ZEW Policy Brief No. 07*, 2022.

Refereeing Activities

Management Science, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Accounting and Public Policy, Junior Management Science

Conferences and Seminars

** indicates presenter; otherwise attendee.*

2026 American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting*, *Nashville, TN*
Economic Growth and Public Policy Conference*, *Chicago, IL*
Texas Tax Theory Seminar, University of Texas at Austin, *Austin, TX*
Norwegian Tax Accounting Symposium, *Bergen, Norway*
SITE Conference Public Economics, *Stanford, CA*
Stanford Accounting Summer Camp, *Stanford, CA*
Texas-Waterloo Taxation Research Symposium, *Waterloo, Canada*

2025 American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting & Doctoral Consortium*, *Dallas, TX*
University of Iowa, Accounting Seminar*, *Iowa City, IA*
Stanford Accounting Summer Camp, *Stanford, CA*
University of Illinois Symposium on Tax Research, *Chicago, IL*
National Tax Association Meetings*, *Boston, MA*
Environmental and Energy Economics Fest*, *Stanford University, CA*

2024 University of Texas at Austin, Accounting Seminar*, *Austin, TX*
American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting & Doctoral Consortium, *Long Beach, CA*
University of Iowa, Accounting Seminar*, *Iowa City, IO*
EIASM Conference on Current Research in Taxation*, *Porto, Portugal*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress*, *Prague, Czechia*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*

2023 CESifo Delphi Conference*, *Hydra, Greece*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*
Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation*, *Vienna, Austria*
Doctoral Seminar by the German Ministry of Finance, *Berlin, Germany*
MannheimTaxation Campus Meeting*, *Mannheim, Germany*
German Ministry of Finance International Tax Policy Symposium, *Berlin, Germany*

2022 Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation*, *Vienna, Austria*
Berlin-Vallendar Conference on Tax Research*, *WHU Vallendar, Germany*
TUM Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business*, *Heilbronn, Germany*
MannheimTaxation Conference*, *Mannheim, Germany*

2021 MannheimTaxation Campus Meeting*, *Mannheim, Germany*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress*, *online*

Invited Discussions

2026 Norwegian Tax Accounting Symposium, *Bergen, Norway*

2025 National Tax Association Meeting, *Boston, MA*

2024 EIASM Conference on Current Research in Taxation, *Porto, Portugal*
International Institute of Public Finance Annual Congress, *Prague, Czechia*
MannheimTaxation Conference, *Mannheim, Germany*
Doctoral Tax Seminar, ZEW, *Mannheim, Germany*

2023 MannheimTaxation Conference, *Mannheim, Germany*
Vienna Doctoral Consortium in Taxation, *Vienna, Austria*
Doctoral Tax Seminar, ZEW, *Mannheim, Germany*

Teaching and Supervision

2026	The Real and Reporting Effects of Business Taxation, PhD Course, *Norwegian School of Economics & ENGAGE.EU* *Teaching Assistant*
2025	Taxes and Business Strategy, Master's, *University of Iowa* *Instructor*
2023–25	Introduction to Scientific Writing, Bachelor's, *University of Mannheim* *Instructor, 3 terms*
2021–25	Introduction to Financial Accounting, Bachelor's, *University of Mannheim* *Teaching Assistant, Taught Exercise Classes, 4 terms*
2020–25	The Role of Taxes for Business Decisions, Master's, *University of Mannheim* *Teaching Assistant, Taught Exercise Classes, 5 terms*
2023	Corporate Socially Responsible Taxation, Master's, *Mannheim Business School* *Guest Lecture*
2021–25	Master's Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (6×) Bachelor's Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (9×) Seminar Thesis Supervision, *University of Mannheim* (4×)

Fellowships and Grants

2025	Lazear Liang Postdoctoral Fellowship, Stanford University, Graduate School of Business
2024	Women Go Abroad DAAD Travel Grant MannheimTaxation Travel Grant American Taxation Association-KPMG Doctoral Consortium Fellow
2023	Gamified Financial Accounting Learning and Accounting Video Library, Foundation for Innovation in University Teaching (Stiftung Innovation in der Hochschullehre), with Philipp Doerrenberg and Johannes Gaul

References

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